

completes it will ask you to log in with your Yahoo!, Google, MSN or AOL account. This login will also pull your contact address book from the particular service, and Mercora will ask you to e-mail at least one of your friends informing them about Mercora. Do that, and you're in.

2. Set up your Media Library

As with other media players, Mercora can scan your hard disk and import all the songs on your PC into its media library.

3. Set up Channels and Go!

You can group your music collection into a maximum of five channels. Drag and drop your music files into each of the channels to set up your channels. You can also record a 90-second audio introduction to your webcasts by clicking on the "Quick Bump" button and using your microphone to record the intro. You are now ready to go! Users wanting to hear your songs will browse the Mercora network to locate your station and stream the songs to their computer.

13.4.2. SHOUTcast

A bit more complex than Mercora, SHOUTcast consists of two components: an audio server called SHOUTcast Distributed Network Audio Server (DNAS) that distributes the streaming audio, and an audio source via a Digital Signal Processing (DSP) plugin to Winamp called SHOUTcast Source.

The DNAS SHOUTcast server requires a dedicated IP address and plenty of bandwidth to handle the audio streams that users will request. Since this is outside the scope of most normal users, we will not get into how to set up the server, but will instead look at how to use the DSP Plug-in to connect to a SHOUTcast hosting server.

1. Download the plugin

Before you install the plugin, ensure that you have the latest version of Winamp (you will find it on any *Digit* CD). Next, go to